WONDER DAILY

How Velcro Works

A strap that rips

A shoe strap rips open, then presses shut and holds. Its plain name is hook and loop: one rough side, one soft.

A burr on a walk

In 1941, burrs stuck to an engineer's socks and his dog. Under a microscope, each spine ended in a tiny hook.

Hooks meet loops

Stiff hooks on one side catch soft loops on the other. One hook is weak, but hundreds together hold strong.

Pull or peel?

A sideways pull is hard, because every hook pulls at once. A peel is easy: only one thin line lets go.

A bag that hangs

A hanging bag pulls along the strip, so every hook shares the weight. Peel one corner, and the bag slides off.

When grip fades

Nylon loops were heated, then snipped into hooks. Lint clogs old hooks, but a fine comb can lift it out.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!